

Security Watch

An Opera Vulnerability

The problem

A vulnerability has been reported in the Opera Web browser, which can be exploited by malicious people to compromise a user's system. Successful exploitation allows execution of arbitrary code when a user visits a malicious Web site—basically meaning that someone could take over your computer.

The vulnerability is caused due to a “boundary error” when processing very long URLs. It has been reported in versions 9.0 and 9.01 on Windows and Linux. Version 8.x is reportedly not affected.

Security firm Secunia has given this vulnerability a “Highly Critical” rating, which is just one notch below its highest security warning.

What to do about it

Simply update to version 9.02. You can download this, the latest version, from www.opera.com.

A Virus With An Anti-virus!

In an unprecedented move for any malware, the SpamThru trojan comes with its own virus scanner—to prevent any other malware from stealing control of the infected machine. The spamming trojan has been touted by security researchers at SecureWorks as the most sophisticated piece of malicious software yet—at par with commercial software, even. It uses P2P to spread itself rather than a mail server, and the virus scanner in question is a pirated copy of Kaspersky AntiVirus.

technology. The surprise announcement even got them appreciation from their rivals.

The Web services protocols are XML standards that are designed to enable better interaction between software from different developers, and with the OSP, Microsoft aims to encourage their use by anyone interested.

It seems like just yesterday we were lobbing acid in their general direction for comments that include (but are not limited to) calling Linux a cancer (Steve Ballmer) and the GPL a Pac-man like confusion (Bill Gates). It is heartening, finally, to note their softening stand towards, and growing support for the open source movement. Be it helping a college student develop the free and open source DotNetNuke or introducing support for administering Linux servers using Windows machines, they've undoubtedly earned considerable brownie points from the community.

Or is this just a devious scheme to destroy the enemy from the inside? Paranoia abounds.

SET TO CATCH UP

An Indian Microsoft?

It's no secret that India is regarded as a major force in the world of IT today. While Indian-written

code powers the backbones of many important organisations and services, you rarely (if ever) see an Indian-developed program being used regularly on the desktop. Strange, isn't it?

Apparently, all that will change in the next decade or two, and analysts expect to see product-oriented companies like Google and Microsoft originate from our shores soon. At the NASSCOM Emerging Companies Forum, Dr Ajay Kela—president of Symphony Services India—said, “The next thing we will see is software product companies emerging out of India. We have been seeing that but the ecosystem for product development has been missing in India, but it is growing now.” This “ecosystem”, he says, owes its existence to the growing entrepreneurial activity in the country. Dr Kela also warns that we don't have the expertise it takes for such a move; this will need to be learnt from companies that have been in the business.

It's not going to happen automatically, though. One of the gripes with the Indian software industry is that it isn't focused around creativity and innovation like it should be, and if we're ever going to rise beyond being just an outsourcing hub, this issue needs to be tackled head-on before anything else. Beyond that, things are sure to look up for Indian software products, or so it seems.

HOT

Small Companies With Big Ideas



Some of the most brilliant ideas we've seen—be it hardware, software or Internet services—have come from small, smart start-ups with a radical idea, loved by millions over the world, and catching the eyes of...

Corporate Big Brothers

With their typical “I-see-I-want-I-buy” attitude, the world's biggest technology companies absorb these start-ups, stripping away the boldness and leaving in their stead a conformist, “propah” organisation. Boo!



“BOOM” BOX DEPT.

Laptop Makers Want Damages From Sony

You might remember the many cases of exploding laptops in these past few months—it resulted in Dell having to recall in excess of 4 million laptop batteries, closely followed by Apple, Toshiba, Hitachi, Fujitsu, Lenovo and now Sony. The Lithium ion time-bombs batteries are all manufactured by Sony, and while only Apple and Dell

One Silly Question

“Where will your computer go after it's dead?”



“How about a graveyard?”
Kaushik Patne



“Computer Heaven!”
Pooja Prabhaka



“Real-World Matrix”
Anjana Krishnan



“The Cyber World, of course!”
Anup Deshmukh



“Ekta Kapoor for rebirth”
Vishali Dhiman